

# Part I: Kitchen Basics

## Setting Up the Kitchen



Chris walks us through his kitchen setup and organization for meal prepping efficiency. From the cabinets and countertops to food storage tips, Chris discusses the basics of setting up a kitchen space to minimize food safety risks while maximizing the shelf life of cooked and uncooked prep ingredients.

### Chris's Key Takeaways

- Plan and organize the kitchen to minimize the required steps for cooking and meal prep.
- Store plates, cookware, cooking appliances, spices, and utensils close to the cooktop for convenience.
- Store kitchen items seldom used furthest away from the cooktop and sink area.
- Organize and use the kitchen as if it were an assembly line.
- Organize the sink and adjacent countertop area to have a trash can and cleaning supplies readily available.
- Use multiple plastic color-coded cutting boards to avoid cross-contamination when preparing various meats and vegetables.
- Designate one towel for cleaning surfaces and one for drying hands.
- Organize foods in the refrigerator to be easily seen and spaced from each other.
- Ensure foods on the refrigerator shelves are not touching the walls to maximize cold air circulation.
- Store raw meats in trays at the very bottom of the refrigerator to minimize the risk of leaking and contamination.
- Store foods that don't require cooler temperatures on the refrigerator doors.
- Use refrigerator doors with a humidity controller to store vegetables to increase shelf life.
- Set the refrigerator thermostat between the ranges 35°F-37°F.
- Placing multiple thermometers on different shelves within the refrigerator promotes greater cooling monitoring.
- Dispose of expired food regularly, freeing any foods blocking the refrigerator air vent.
- Frequently organize foods in the freezer to minimize clutter.